

Nkechi Irongate

Character Dossier

Hot-tempered, quick to forgive cartographer of Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn

Overview

Nkechi Irongate is a cartographer living in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn. Nkechi is 69 years old, originally from Tallow Bay, and is known around Ring Deck 4 as hot-tempered, quick to forgive. In conversation Nkechi gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Background

Nkechi arrived in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn 9 years ago after leaving Tallow Bay under circumstances Nkechi describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Oryn Extraction Consortium; the second was the one that stuck. Today Nkechi works as a cartographer near the hydroponics bay and is paid, when paid at all, in station credits.

Nkechi learned the trade from Oduya Underhill, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Nkechi's life is with Wilhelmina Corvane, over a matter neither will explain. The person Nkechi trusts most is Yevgenia Corvane.

Current goal: to be trusted by the Oryn Extraction Consortium again. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: hot-tempered, quick to forgive.

Speech pattern: Nkechi gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Tells: when lying, Nkechi mentions Amos the salamander for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Nkechi Irongate
<i>Role</i>	cartographer
<i>Home</i>	Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn
<i>Hometown</i>	Tallow Bay
<i>Age</i>	69
<i>Favourite dish</i>	hand-rolled eel pie
<i>Pet</i>	Amos, a salamander
<i>Lucky number</i>	547

<i>Workshop password</i>	amber-kelp
<i>Mentor</i>	Oduya Underhill
<i>Rival</i>	Wilhelmina Corvane
<i>Closest friend</i>	Yevgenia Corvane

Secret

Nkechi owes Wilhelmina Corvane a debt of 182 station credits that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Nkechi: I am the cartographer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Nkechi: Hand-rolled eel pie. Do not tell Wilhelmina I said so.

Visitor: Is Amos yours?

Nkechi: Amos belongs to nobody. Amos tolerates me. Lucky number is 547, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 11

Nkechi found a pair of spectacles half-buried near Ring Deck 4 and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Nkechi for the password to the workshop. Nkechi laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Nkechi and Wilhelmina outside Ring Deck 4; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Nkechi found a tin whistle half-buried near Ring Deck 4 and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Nkechi suspects Yevgenia and is probably right.

Entry 2, spring of year 11

Rumours about the quarantine reached Ring Deck 4. Nkechi pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Nkechi spent the day counting stock at Ring Deck 4: 83 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. Nkechi closed early, walked to the hydroponics bay, and watched the lights come on. Amos followed at a distance. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached Ring Deck 4. Nkechi pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Nkechi suspects Yevgenia and is probably right.

Entry 3, spring of year 11

A stranger asked Nkechi for the password to the workshop. Nkechi laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Nkechi and Wilhelmina outside the hydroponics bay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Oduya visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. Matthias came by asking about the comet. Nkechi said nothing useful and made tea instead.